

● HARD

● ALGEBRA

● ANSWER KEY

Algebra

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Q1**59/9**

Accept also: 6.555, 6.556

The correct answer is $\frac{59}{9}$. When the graph of an equation in the form $Ax + By = C$, where A , B , and C are constants, is translated down k units in the xy -plane, the resulting graph can be represented by the equation $Ax + By + k = C$. It's given that the graph of $9x - 10y = 19$ is translated down 4 units in the xy -plane. Therefore, the resulting graph can be represented by the equation $9x - 10y + 4 = 19$, or $9x - 10y - 40 = 19$. Adding 40 to both sides of this equation yields $9x - 10y = 59$. The x -coordinate of the x -intercept of the graph of an equation in the xy -plane is the value of x in the equation when $y = 0$. Substituting 0 for y in the equation $9x - 10y = 59$ yields $9x - 10(0) = 59$, or $9x = 59$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 9 yields $x = \frac{59}{9}$. Therefore, the x -coordinate of the x -intercept of the resulting graph is $\frac{59}{9}$. Note that 59/9, 6.555, and 6.556 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Q2**B****B. -4**

Choice B is correct. It's given that $f(3x) = x - 6$ for all values of x . If $3x = 6$, then $f(3x)$ will equal $f(6)$. Dividing both sides of $3x = 6$ by 3 gives $x = 2$. Therefore, substituting 2 for x in the given equation yields $f(3 \times 2) = 2 - 6$, which can be rewritten as $f(6) = -4$.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the value of the constant in the given equation for f . Choice C is incorrect and may result from substituting $x = 6$, rather than $x = 2$, into the given equation. Choice D is incorrect. This is the value of x that yields $f(6)$ for the left-hand side of the given equation; it's not the value of $f(6)$.

Q3**A**

A. $12x + 6 \leq x + x + 4 - 26$

Choice A is correct. It's given that the four odd integers are consecutive, ordered from least to greatest, and that the first odd integer is represented by x . It follows that the second odd integer is represented by $x + 2$, the third odd integer is represented by $x + 4$, and the fourth odd integer is represented by $x + 6$. Therefore, the product of 12 and the fourth odd integer is represented by $12x + 6$, and 26 less than the sum of the first and third odd integers is represented by $x + x + 4 - 26$. Since the product of 12 and the fourth odd integer is at most 26 less than the sum of the first and third odd integers, it follows that $12x + 6 \leq x + x + 4 - 26$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice C is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q4**-.3266**

Accept also: $-.3267$, $-49/150$

The correct answer is $-.3267$. Applying the distributive property to the right-hand side of the given equation yields $0.8t - 0.46 = 8t - 0.008 + 1.9$, or $0.8t - 0.46 = 8t + 1.892$. Subtracting $0.8t$ from both sides of this equation yields $-0.46 = 7.2t + 1.892$. Subtracting 1.892 from both sides of this equation yields $-2.352 = 7.2t$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 7.2 yields $\frac{-2.352}{7.2} = t$. Therefore, the value of t is approximately -0.32667 . Note that $-.3267$, $-.3266$, -0.326 , and -0.327 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Q5**B**

B. $x + 3y = -20$

Choice B is correct. A system of two linear equations written in standard form has no solution when the equations are distinct and the ratio of the x-coefficient to the y-coefficient for one equation is equivalent to the ratio of the x-coefficient to the y-coefficient for the other equation. This ratio for the given equation is 2 to 6, or 1 to 3. Only choice B is an equation that isn't equivalent to the given equation and whose ratio of the x-coefficient to the y-coefficient is 1 to 3.

Choice A is incorrect. Multiplying each of the terms in this equation by 2 yields an equation that is equivalent to the given equation. This system would have infinitely many solutions. Choices C and D are incorrect. The ratio of the x-coefficient to the y-coefficient in $6x - 2y = 0$ (choice C) is -6 to 2, or -3 to 1. This ratio in $6x + 2y = 10$ (choice D) is 6 to 2, or 3 to 1. Since neither of these ratios is equivalent to that for the given equation, these systems would have exactly one solution.

Q6**C**

C. $\frac{24}{7}$

Choice C is correct. It's given from the graph that the points $0, 7$ and $8, 0$ lie on the line. For two points on a line, x_1, y_1 and x_2, y_2 , the slope of the line can be calculated using the slope formula $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$. Substituting $0, 7$ for x_1, y_1 and $8, 0$ for x_2, y_2 in this formula, the slope of the line can be calculated as $m = \frac{0 - 7}{8 - 0}$, or $m = -\frac{7}{8}$. It's also given that the point $d, 4$ lies on the line.

Substituting $d, 4$ for x_1, y_1 , $8, 0$ for x_2, y_2 , and $-\frac{7}{8}$ for m in the slope formula yields $-\frac{7}{8} = \frac{0 - 4}{8 - d}$, or $-\frac{7}{8} = \frac{-4}{8 - d}$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by $8 - d$ yields $-\frac{7}{8}(8 - d) = -4$. Expanding the left-hand side of this equation yields $-7 + \frac{7}{8}d = -4$. Adding 7 to both sides of this equation yields $\frac{7}{8}d = 3$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by $\frac{8}{7}$ yields $d = \frac{24}{7}$. Thus, the value of d is $\frac{24}{7}$.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the value of y when $x = 4$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Q7**B****B. $(-4,0)$**

Choice B is correct. The equation of a linear function can be written in the form $y = mx + b$, where $y = f(x)$, m is the slope of the graph of $y = f(x)$, and b is the y -coordinate of the y -intercept of the graph. The value of m can be found using the slope formula, $m = \frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$. According to the table, the points $(-11, 21)$ and $(-10, 18)$ lie on the graph of $y = f(x)$. Using these two points in the slope formula yields $m = \frac{18 - 21}{-10 - (-11)}$, or -3 . Substituting -3 for m in the slope-intercept form of the equation yields $y = -3x + b$. The value of b can be found by substituting values from the table and solving; for example, substituting the coordinates of the point $(-11, 21)$ into the equation $y = -3x + b$ gives $21 = -3(-11) + b$, which yields $b = -12$. This means the function given by the table can be represented by the equation $y = -3x - 12$. The value of the x -intercept of the graph of $y = f(x)$ can be determined by finding the value of x when $y = 0$. Substituting $y = 0$ into $y = -3x - 12$ yields $0 = -3x - 12$, or $x = -4$. This corresponds to the point $(-4, 0)$.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from substituting the value of the slope for the x -coordinate of the x -intercept. Choice C is incorrect and may result from a calculation error. Choice D is incorrect and may result from substituting the y -coordinate of the y -intercept for the x -coordinate of the x -intercept.

Q8**182**

The correct answer is 182. Let s represent the number of small candles the owner can purchase, and let l represent the number of large candles the owner can purchase. It's given that the owner pays \$ 4.90 per candle to purchase small candles and \$ 11.60 per candle to purchase large candles. Therefore, the owner pays $4.90s$ dollars for s small candles and $11.60l$ dollars for l large candles, which means the owner pays a total of $4.90s + 11.60l$ dollars to purchase candles. It's given that the owner budgets \$ 2,200 to purchase candles. Therefore, $4.90s + 11.60l \leq 2,200$. It's also given that the owner must purchase a minimum of 200 candles. Therefore, $s + l \geq 200$. The inequalities $4.90s + 11.60l \leq 2,200$ and $s + l \geq 200$ can be combined into one compound inequality by rewriting the second inequality so that its left-hand side is equivalent to the left-hand side of the first inequality. Subtracting l from both sides of the inequality $s + l \geq 200$ yields $s \geq 200 - l$. Multiplying both sides of this inequality by 4.90 yields $4.90s \geq 4.90(200 - l)$, or $4.90s \geq 980 - 4.90l$. Adding $11.60l$ to both sides of this inequality yields $4.90s + 11.60l \geq 980 - 4.90l + 11.60l$, or $4.90s + 11.60l \geq 980 + 6.70l$. This inequality can be combined with the inequality $4.90s + 11.60l \leq 2,200$, which yields the compound inequality $980 + 6.70l \leq 4.90s + 11.60l \leq 2,200$. It follows that $980 + 6.70l \leq 2,200$. Subtracting 980 from both sides of this inequality yields $6.70l \leq 2,200$. Dividing both sides of this inequality by 6.70 yields approximately $l \leq 182.09$. Since the number of large candles the owner purchases must be a whole number, the maximum number of large candles the owner can purchase is the largest whole number less than 182.09, which is 182.

Q9**20**

The correct answer is 20. Adding the first equation to the second equation in the given system yields $5y - 5y = 10x + 5x + 11 - 21$, or $0 = 15x - 10$. Adding 10 to both sides of this equation yields $10 = 15x$. Multiplying both sides of this equation by 2 yields $20 = 30x$. Therefore, the value of $30x$ is 20.

Q10

5

The correct answer is 5. It's given that the equation $10x + 15y = 85$ represents the situation, where x is the number of on-site training courses, y is the number of online training courses, and 85 is the total number of hours of training courses the apprentice has enrolled in.

Therefore, $10x$ represents the number of hours the apprentice has enrolled in on-site training courses, and $15y$ represents the number of hours the apprentice has enrolled in online training courses. Since x is the number of on-site training courses and y is the number of online training courses the apprentice has enrolled in, 10 is the number of hours each on-site course takes and 15 is the number of hours each online course takes. Subtracting these numbers gives $15 - 10$, or 5 more hours each online training course takes than each on-site training course.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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